

CDN Incident Alert: 0081. TLP: CLEAR		Date
Title	EU Russian officials, state media and pro-Kremlin actors spread claims of Ukraine and Europe preparing false flag attacks	14/08/2025

Summary

Russian officials, state media and pro-Kremlin actors have been spreading propaganda claims accusing Ukraine and its European allies of planning false-flag attacks to sabotage the summit between Donald Trump and Vladimir Putin or the Zapad-2025 military exercise. The aim of these claims is likely to discredit Ukraine and its European allies ahead of the summit in Alaska, portray them as aggressors and distract from Russia's own attacks on Ukraine. It can also not be excluded that Russian actors are setting up information conditions for their own attacks or acts of sabotage.

Authorities in the EU and the UK should monitor closely the information space ahead of the summit in Alaska and around the Zapad-2025 military exercise. Social media platforms should take measures against the spread of content from sanctioned state actors and ensure there are mechanisms such as fact-checking or community notes in place to provide context to posts by known pro-Kremlin actors.

Incident

- On 12 August, Russian Ministry of Defence issued a [statement](#) accusing Ukraine of planning a false flag attack on civilians in Chuhuiv to sabotage the Trump-Putin meeting. The claim was picked up and spread online by the [Russian Ministry of Foreign Affairs](#), Russian state media such as [RT](#), [Rossija 24](#), [RIA Novosti](#) and [Sputnik](#), the [Pravda network](#) and pro-Kremlin influencers such as [Chay Bowes](#), [Alina Lipp](#) and [Sonja van den Ende](#).
- On 11 August, RIA Novosti [claimed](#), citing pro-Russian Ukrainian ex-MP Vladimir Oleynik, who is now part of the propaganda project "Other Ukraine," that Ukraine could stage a "Bucha 2.0" together with Europeans to sabotage the meeting between Putin and Trump. A similar claim has been made in a [column](#) published by RIA Novosti on the same day. US conspiracy influencer Alex Jones picked up the claim on 11 August in a [post](#) on X. The claim was spread as well as in posts by German pro-Kremlin Telegram channels ([here](#), [here](#) and [here](#)).
- On 8 August, the Russian state news agency RIA Novosti [claimed](#) that Ukrainian and Polish intelligence services together with Belarusian opposition figures in exile were preparing a "provocation" to sabotage the Zapad 2025 drills.
- On 4 August, Russian Foreign Intelligence Agency SVR [accused](#) the United Kingdom of preparing false flag attacks on Russian "shadow fleet". [The claim was also spread by the Russian Foreign Ministry and Russian state media RT, Sputnik and Tass.](#)
- Starting from July 27, pro-Russian German activist Ralph Niemeyer began claiming that a NATO attack on Kaliningrad will likely take place during the Zapad 2025 military exercises. Niemeyer [posted](#) the claim on his Telegram channel and repeated it in an interview with the Russian state news agency [RIA Novosti](#). According to Niemeyer, the attack will be justified by accusations that Russia is interfering with GPS signals. His claims were picked up by Russian-language state-affiliated and pro-Kremlin media outlets such as [Rossiyskaya Gazeta](#), [Tsargrad TV](#), [Komsomolskaya Pravda](#), and [local media](#) in Kaliningrad. Niemeyer spent several weeks in Kaliningrad, where he [participated](#) in a Russian-organised "peace run" and an [event](#) with the "Night wolves". On August 6, he [claimed](#) again in his Telegram channel that "the Balts are plotting a new 'Gleiwitz incident'".

Narrative

Meta narrative: Ukraine and its Western allies are planning false flag attacks against Russia, Belarus or civilians in Ukraine.

Sub-narratives: Ukraine is planning a false flag attack on civilians in Chuhuiv; Ukraine and Europe, particularly the UK are planning a “Bucha 2.0”; Ukrainian and Polish secret services as well as Polish exile opposition figures are planning a provocation to sabotage Zapad-2025 drills; NATO is planning an attack on Kaliningrad during the Zapad-2025 drills; the UK is planning a false flag attack against the Russian “shadow fleet”.

Impact

Reach: On X, posts by RT reached up to 426K views despite the account being sanctioned and geoblocked in the EU. A [post](#) by Alex Jones received 109K views, a post by Chay Bowes received 105K views as of 13 August.

Outcome: n/a

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: T0066: [Degrade Adversary](#) – Russian actors are trying to discredit Ukraine and its European allies

Objective: T0077: [Distract](#) – they are also trying to shift attention from the fact that Russia is continuing its aggression against Ukraine and has not given up its maximalist war goals of political control over Ukraine

T0022.002: [Develop Original Conspiracy Theory Narratives](#) – Russian state actors developed new narratives of allegedly planned false flag attacks

T0068: [Respond to Breaking News Event or Active Crisis](#) – narratives are spread around the Trump-Putin summit, an event that draws much attention and speculations

T0110: [Formal Diplomatic Channels](#) – the narratives were spread online by officials and the Foreign Ministry

T0111: [Traditional Media](#) – the narratives were spread by state media

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action taken: Alert issued.

Recommendations: Authorities in the EU and the UK should monitor closely the information space ahead on the summit in Alaska and around the Zapad-2025 military exercise. Social media platforms should take measure against spread of content from sanctioned state actors and ensure there are mechanisms such as fact checking or community notes in place to provide context to posts by known pro-Kremlin actors.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
n/a	Russia		Julia Smirnova, CeMAS	X, Telegram	